Specification of the controlled designation of origin "MERCUREY"

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Mercurey", initially recognised by the decree of 11 September 1936.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

1 – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the term "premier cru" for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for this term in the present specification.

2 – The name of the controlled designation of origin, whether or not supplemented by the term "premier cru", may be followed by one of the following climat denominations, for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for the indication of one of these denominations in the present specification:

- "Clos de Paradis";
- "Clos des Barraults";
- "Clos des grands Voyens";
- "Clos des Myglands";
- "Clos Marcilly";
- "Clos Tonnerre";
- "Clos Voyens";
- "Grand Clos Fortoul";
- "Griffères";
- "La Bondue";
- "La Cailloute";
- "La Chassière";
- "La Levrière";
- "La Mission";
- "Le Clos du Roy";
- "Le Clos l'Evêque";
- "Les Byots";
- "Les Champs Martin";
- "Les Combins";
- "Les Crêts";
- "Les Croichots";
- "Les Fourneaux";
- "Les Montaigus" (parcels A1 to A45 only);

- "Les Montaigus";

- "Les Naugues";

- "Les Puillets";

- "Les Ruelles";

- "Les Saumonts";

- "Les Vasées";

- "Les Velley";

- "Sazenay".

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Mercurey" is reserved for still white and red wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1 – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Saône-et-Loire department: Mercurey and Saint-Martin-sous-Montaigu.

2 – Delimited parcel area

a) – The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 7 and 8 November 1990, of 5 and 6 November 1997 and of 26 and 27 February 2003.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

b) – Wines eligible for the term "premier cru", or for a climat denomination, or for both, come exclusively from vines situated within the specific delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 7 and 8 November 1990, of 5 and 6 November 1997 and of 26 and 27 February 2003, and situated in the lieux-dits listed in the table below.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

CLIMAT	**LIEU-DIT**	**COMMUNE**
"Clos de Paradis"	La Boudaillerie (in part)	SAINT-MARTIN-SOUS-MONTAIGU
	Le Paradis (in part)	
"Clos des Barraults"	Le Clos des Baraults	MERCUREY
"Clos des grands Voyens"	Clos des grands Voyens	MERCUREY
	Jamproye (in part)	MERCUREY
"Clos des Myglands"	Clos Miglan	MERCUREY
"Clos Marcilly"	Le Marcilly	MERCUREY
"Clos Tonnerre"	Clos Tonnère	MERCUREY

CLIMAT	**LIEU-DIT**	**COMMUNE**
"Clos Voyens"	Clos Voyens	MERCUREY
"Grand Clos Fortoul"	Grand Clos Fortoul	MERCUREY
"Griffères"	Vigne de Maillonge (in part)	MERCUREY
"La Bondue"	En Sazenay (in part)	MERCUREY
	La Bondue (in part)	MERCUREY
"La Cailloute"	La Cailloute	MERCUREY
"La Chassière"	La Chassière (in part)	SAINT-MARTIN-SOUS-MONTAIGU
"La Levrière"	La Levrière	MERCUREY
"La Mission"	La Mission	MERCUREY
"Le Clos du Roy"	Le Clos du Roi	MERCUREY
"Le Clos l'Evêque"	Le Clos l'Evêque	MERCUREY
"Les Byots"	Les Byots	MERCUREY
"Les Champs Martin"	Les Champs Martin	MERCUREY
"Les Combins"	Les Combins	MERCUREY
"Les Crêts"	Les Crêts	MERCUREY
"Les Croichots"	Les Champs Michaux (in part)	MERCUREY
	Les Croichots	
"Les Fourneaux"	Les Fourneaux	SAINT-MARTIN-SOUS-MONTAIGU
"Les Montaigus" (parcels A1 to A45 only)	Clos des Montaigus	SAINT-MARTIN-SOUS-MONTAIGU
	Les Montaigus	
"Les Montaigus"	A la Serve	SAINT-MARTIN-SOUS-MONTAIGU
	A la Verrière	
	Les Montaigus	
"Les Naugues"	Les Naugues	MERCUREY
"Les Puillets"	Les Puillets	MERCUREY
"Les Ruelles"	En Ruelle (in part)	SAINT-MARTIN-SOUS-MONTAIGU
"Les Saumonts"	Les Saumonts (in part)	MERCUREY
"Les Vasées"	Les Vasées	MERCUREY
"Les Velley"	Les Chavances (in part)	MERCUREY
	Les Vellées (in part)	
"Sazenay"	En Sazenay (in part)	MERCUREY

3 – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes:

- Côte-d'Or department: Agencourt, Aloxe-Corton, Ancey, Arcenant, Argilly, Autricourt, Auxey-Duresses, Baubigny, Beaune, Belan-sur-Ource, Bévy, Bissey-la-Côte, Bligny-lès-Beaune, Boncourt-le-Bois, Bouix, Bouze-lès-Beaune, Brion-sur-Ource, Brochon, Cérilly, Chambolle-Musigny, Chambœuf, Channay, Charrey-sur-Seine, Chassagne-Montrachet, Châtillon-sur-Seine, Chaumont-le-Bois, Chaux, Chenôve, Chevannes, Chorey-lès-Beaune, Clémencey, Collonges-lès-Bévy, Combertault, Comblanchien, Corcelles-les-Arts, Corcelles-les-Monts, Corgoloin, Cormot-le-Grand, Corpeau, Couchey, Curley, Curtil-Vergy, Daix, Dijon, Ebaty, Echevronne, Epernay-sous-Gevrey, L'Etang-Vergy, Etrochey, Fixin, Flagey-Echézeaux, Flavignerot, Fleurey-sur-Ouche, Fussey, Gerland, Gevrey-Chambertin, Gilly-lès-Cîteaux, Gomméville, Grancey-sur-Ource, Griselles, Ladoix-Serrigny, Lantenay, Larrey, Levernois, Magny-lès-Villers, Mâlain, Marcenay, Marey-lès-Fussey, Marsannay-la-Côte, Massingy, Mavilly-Mandelot, Meloisey, Merceuil, Messanges, Meuilley, Meursanges, Meursault, Molesme, Montagny-lès-Beaune, Monthelie, Montliot-et-Courcelles, Morey-Saint-Denis, Mosson, Nantoux, Nicey, Noiron-sur-Seine, Nolay, Nuits-Saint-Georges, Obtrée, Pernand-Vergelesses, Perrigny-lès-Dijon, Plombières-lès-Dijon, Poinçon-lès-Larrey, Pommard, Pothières, Premeaux-Prissey, Prusly-sur-Ource, Puligny-Montrachet, Quincey, Reulle-Vergy, La Rochepot, Ruffey-lès-Beaune, Saint-Aubin, Saint-Bernard, Saint-Philibert, Saint-Romain, Sainte-Colombe-sur-Seine, Sainte-Marie-la-Blanche, Santenay, Savigny-lès-Beaune, Segrois, Tailly, Talant, Thoires, Vannaire, Vauchignon, Velars-sur-Ouche, Vertault, Vignoles, Villars-Fontaine, Villebichot, Villedieu, Villers-la-Faye, Villers-Patras, Villy-le-Moutier, Vix, Volnay, Vosne-Romanée and Vougeot.

- Rhône department: Alix, Anse, L'Arbresle, Les Ardillats, Arnas, Bagnols, Beaujeu, Belleville, Belmont-d'Azergues, Blacé, Le Bois-d'Oingt, Le Breuil, Bully, Cercié, Chambost-Allières, Chamelet, Charentay, Charnay, Châtillon, Chazay-d'Azergues, Chénas, Chessy, Chiroubles, Cogny, Corcelles-en-Beaujolais, Dareizé, Denicé, Dracé, Emeringes, Fleurie, Frontenas, Gleizé, Jarnioux, Juliénas, Jullié, Lacenas, Lachassagne, Lancié, Lantignié, Légny, Létra, Liergues, Limas, Lozanne, Lucenay, Marchampt, Marcy, Moiré, Montmelas-Saint-Sorlin, Morancé, Nuelles, Odenas, Oingt, Les Olmes, Le Perréon, Pommiers, Pouilly-le-Monial, Quincié-en-Beaujolais, Régnié-Durette, Rivolet, Saint-Clément-sur-Valsonne, Saint-Cyr-le-Chatoux, Saint-Didier-sur-Beaujeu, Saint-Etienne-des-Oullières, Saint-Etienne-la-Varenne, Saint-Georges-de-Reneins, Saint-Germain-sur-l'Arbresle, Saint-Jean-d'Ardières, Saint-Jean-des-Vignes, Saint-Julien, Saint-Just-d'Avray, Saint-Lager, Saint-Laurent-d'Oingt, Saint-Loup, Saint-Romain-de-Popey, Saint-Vérand, Sainte-Paule, Salles-Arbuissonnas-en-Beaujolais, Sarcey, Taponas, Ternand, Theizé, Vaux-en-Beaujolais, Vauxrenard, Vernay, Villefranche-sur-Saône, Ville-sur-Jarnioux and Villié-Morgon.

- Saône-et-Loire department: Aluze, Ameugny, Azé, Barizey, Beaumont-sur-Grosne, Berzé-la-Ville, Berzé-le-Châtel, Bissey-sous-Cruchaud, Bissy-la-Mâconnaise, Bissy-sous-Uxelles, Bissy-sur-Fley, Blanot, Bonnay, Bouzeron, Boyer, Bray, Bresse-sur-Grosne, Burgy, Burnand, Bussières, Buxy, Cersot, Chagny, Chaintré, Chalon-sur-Saône, Chamilly, Champagny-sous-Uxelles, Champforgeuil, Chânes, Change, Chapaize, La Chapelle-de-Bragny, La Chapelle-de-Guinchay, La Chapelle-sous-Brancion, Charbonnières, Chardonnay, La Charmée, Charnay-lès-Mâcon, Charrecey, Chasselas, Chassey-le-Camp, Château, Châtenoy-le-Royal, Chaudenay, Cheilly-lès-Maranges, Chenôves, Chevagny-lès-Chevrières, Chissey-lès-Mâcon, Clessé, Cluny, Cormatin, Cortambert, Cortevaix, Couches, Crêches-sur-Saône, Créot, Cruzille, Culles-les-Roches, Curtil-sous-Burnand, Davayé, Demigny, Dennevy, Dezize-lès-Maranges, Donzy-le-National, Donzy-le-Pertuis, Dracy-le-Fort, Dracy-lès-Couches, Epertully, Etrigny, Farges-lès-Chalon, Farges-lès-Mâcon, Flagy, Fleurville, Fley, Fontaines, Fuissé, Genouilly, Germagny, Givry, Granges, Grevilly, Hurigny, Igé, Jalogny, Jambles, Jugy, Jully-lès-Buxy, Lacrost, Laives, Laizé, Lalheue, Leynes, Lournand, La Loyère, Lugny, Mâcon, Malay, Mancey, Martailly-lès-Brancion, Massilly, Massy, Mellecey, Messey-sur-Grosne, Milly-Lamartine, Montagny-

lès-Buxy, Montbellet, Montceaux-Ragny, Moroges, Nanton, Ozenay, Paris-l'Hôpital, Péronne, Pierreclos, Plottes, Préty, Prissé, Pruzilly, Remigny, La Roche-Vineuse, Romanèche-Thorins, Rosey, Royer, Rully, Saint-Albain, Saint-Ambreuil, Saint-Amour-Bellevue, Saint-Boil, Saint-Clément-sur-Guye, Saint-Denis-de-Vaux, Saint-Désert, Saint-Gengoux-de-Scissé, Saint-Gengoux-le-National, Saint-Germain-lès-Buxy, Saint-Gervais-sur-Couches, Saint-Gilles, Saint-Jean-de-Trézy, Saint-Jean-de-Vaux, Saint-Léger-sur-Dheune, Saint-Mard-de-Vaux, Saint-Martin-Belle-Roche, Saint-Martin-du-Tartre, Saint-Maurice-de-Satonnay, Saint-Maurice-des-Champs, Saint-Maurice-lès-Couches, Saint-Pierre-de-Varennes, Saint-Rémy, Saint-Sernin-du-Plain, Saint-Symphorien-d'Ancelles, Saint-Vallerin, Saint-Vérand, Saint-Ythaire, Saisy, La Salle, Salornay-sur-Guye, Sampigny-lès-Maranges, Sancé, Santilly, Sassangy, Saules, Savigny-sur-Grosne, Sennecey-le-Grand, Senozan, Sercy, Serrières, Sigy-le-Châtel, Sologny, Solutré-Pouilly, Taizé, Tournus, Uchizy, Varennes-lès-Mâcon, Vaux-en-Pré, Vergisson, Vers, Verzé, Le Villars, La Vineuse, Vinzelles and Viré.

- Yonne department: Accolay, Aigremont, Annay-sur-Serin, Arcy-sur-Cure, Asquins, Augy, Auxerre, Avallon, Bazarnes, Beine, Bernouil, Béru, Bessy-sur-Cure, Bleigny-le-Carreau, Censy, Chablis, Champlay, Champs-sur-Yonne, Champvallon, Chamvres, La Chapelle-Vaupelteigne, Charentenay, Châtel-Gérard, Chemilly-sur-Serein, Cheney, Chevannes, Chichée, Chitry, Collan, Coulangeron, Coulanges-la-Vineuse, Courgis, Cravant, Cruzy-le-Châtel, Dannemoine, Dyé, Epineuil, Escamps, Escolives-Sainte-Camille, Fleys, Fontenay-près-Chablis, Gy-l'Evêque, Héry, Irancy, Island, Joigny, Jouancy, Junay, Jussy, Lichères-près-Aigremont, Lignorelles, Ligny-le-Châtel, Lucy-sur-Cure, Maligny, Mélisey, Merry-Sec, Migé, Molay, Molosmes, Montigny-la-Resle, Mouffy, Moulins-en-Tonnerois, Nitry, Noyers, Ouanne, Paroy-sur-Tholon, Pasilly, Pierre-Perthuis, Poilly-sur-Serein, Pontigny, Préhy, Quenne, Roffey, Rouvray, Sacy, Saint-Bris-le-Vineux, Saint-Cyr-les-Colons, Saint-Père, Sainte-Pallaye, Sainte-Vertu, Sarry, Senan, Serrigny, Tharoiseau, Tissey, Tonnerre, Tronchoy, Val-de-Mercy, Vallan, Venouse, Venoy, Vermenton, Vézannes, Vézelay, Vézinnes, Villeneuve-Saint-Salves, Villiers-sur-Tholon, Villy, Vincelles, Vincelottes, Viviers, Volgré and Yrouerre.

V. – Grape varieties

1 – Grape varieties

a) – The red wines come from the following varieties:

- main variety: pinot noir N;

- accessory variety: chardonnay B.

b) – The white wines come from the chardonnay B and pinot gris G varieties.

2 – Proportion rules on the holding

For the red wines, the accessory varieties are authorised only as mixed plantings within the vines, and their total proportion is limited to 15 % within each parcel.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1 – Training methods

a) – Planting density

The vines have a minimum planting density of 8,000 plants per hectare, with a spacing between rows that may not exceed 1.40 metres and a spacing between plants within the same row that may not be less than 0.80 metre. Vines planted "en foule" (randomly, without rows) have a spacing between plants within the same row greater than 0.50 metre.

b) – Pruning rules

The red wines come from vines pruned according to the following provisions:

- either short pruning (vines trained as Royat cordon and fan): each plant bears four spurs, each with a maximum of two free eyes. Each plant may not bear more than eight free eyes. Cordons are rejuvenated in such a way that in no case does the total number of free eyes per plant exceed eight;

- or long pruning (vines trained in single Guyot): each plant bears a single cane with a maximum of six free eyes and one spur with two free eyes. Each plant may not bear more than eight free eyes.

The white wines come from vines pruned according to the following provisions:

- either short pruning (vines trained as Royat cordon): each plant bears five spurs, each with a maximum of two free eyes. Each plant may not bear more than ten free eyes. Cordons are rejuvenated in such a way that in no case does the total number of free eyes per plant exceed ten;

- or long pruning (vines trained in single Guyot): each plant bears a single cane with a maximum of six free eyes and two spurs with two free eyes, or a single cane with a maximum of eight free eyes and a single spur with two free eyes. Each plant may not bear more than ten free eyes.

Whatever the pruning method, the vines may be pruned with additional free eyes provided that, at the phenological stage corresponding to 11 or 12 leaves, the number of fruit-bearing shoots of the year per plant is less than or equal to the number of free eyes defined in the pruning rules.

c) – Trellising and foliage height rules

- The vines must be trellised and the trellising is maintained.

- The height of trellised foliage must be at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, set at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper trimming limit, set at least 0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set at:

- 9,000 kilograms per hectare for the red wines;

- 10,500 kilograms per hectare for the white wines.

e) – Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 644-22 of the Rural Code is set at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, reflected in particular by:

- control of a good sanitary condition, making it possible to obtain healthy foliage and healthy berries;

- upkeep of the soil, namely control of grass cover by a grass height of less than half the trellising height (height between the ground and the upper trellising wire), and control of erosion through the absence of visible roots.

2 – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the soils, which constitute a fundamental element of the terroir:

- Permanent grass cover of the headlands is compulsory.

- Any substantial modification of the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer or the structuring elements of the landscape of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of

origin is prohibited, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works.

b) – Vine plantings and replacements may only be made with healthy plant material that has undergone hot-water treatment or any other method making it possible to combat flavescence dorée.

3 – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1 – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness.

b) – Particular harvesting provisions

No particular provision.

c) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest

The harvest must be protected from rain during its transport and on its reception.

2 – Ripeness of the grapes

The sugar content of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume of the wines meet the following characteristics:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	**MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)**	**MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
White wines	178	11.0 %
Red wines	180	10.5 %
Wines eligible for the denomination of a climat that may be associated with the term "premier cru"		
White wines	187	11.5 %
Red wines	189	11.0 %

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1 – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 644-25 of the Rural Code is set at:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	**YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)**
White wines	57
Red wines	50
Wines eligible for the denomination of a climat that may be associated with the term "premier cru"	
White wines	55
Red wines	48

2 – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 644-25 of the Rural Code is set at:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	**LIMIT YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)**
White wines	64
Red wines	58
Wines eligible for the denomination of a climat that may be associated with the term "premier cru"	
White wines	62
Red wines	56

3 – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1 – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Reception and pressing

No particular provision.

b) – Blending of varieties

Where red wines are produced from parcels containing chardonnay plants as defined in point V 1 a), the wines are vinified by blending the grapes concerned, within the limit of 15 %.

c) – Malolactic fermentation

At the packaging stage, red wines have a maximum malic acid content of 0.4 gram per litre.

d) – Analytical standards

Finished wines ready to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 644-36-I of the Rural Code have a maximum fermentable sugar content (glucose + fructose) of:

- 3 grams per litre for white wines, or 4 grams per litre if the total acidity, expressed as H2SO4, is greater than or equal to 2.7 grams per litre;

- 2 grams per litre for red wines.

e) – Oenological practices and physical treatments

- Subtractive enrichment techniques (TSE) are authorised for red wines within the limit of a maximum concentration rate of 10 %. The equipment used is fitted with a meter allowing the volume of water removed to be declared.

- The use of pieces of wood is prohibited.

After enrichment, the total alcoholic strength by volume of the wines meets the following characteristics:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	**MAXIMUM TOTAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
"Mercurey"	13.5 %
"Mercurey" eligible for the denomination of a climat that may be associated with the term "premier cru"	14.0 %

f) – Prohibited equipment

Continuous presses are prohibited.

g) – Overall vat capacity

Every operator must have an overall vat capacity (vinification and storage) equivalent to at least:

- for white and rosé wines, the volume of wine vinified for the previous year's harvest, as entered either on the harvest declaration, pro rata to the change in the holding's area in production, or on the production declaration;

- for red wines, 150 % of the volume of wine vinified for the previous year's harvest, as entered either on the harvest declaration, pro rata to the change in the holding's area in production, or on the production declaration.

h) – Good overall state of upkeep of the cellar (floor and walls) and of the equipment (hygiene)

The cellar and the equipment are well maintained; this is reflected in particular by:

- general hygiene of the elaboration premises, with general cleanliness, well-maintained floors, adequate drainage and a surface avoiding stagnation;

- harmlessness of the equipment and products coming into contact with the wine;

- separation and specificity of the premises: premises without the same functions must be separated, such as storage areas for plant-protection products, cleaning products or hydrocarbons, from the premises for vinification, ageing and storage of dry goods (corks, cartons);

- management of wine effluents: effluents must be removed as quickly as possible from foodstuff premises and deposited in well-maintained containers that are easy to clean and can be closed. Waste storage areas must be kept clean; waste must be disposed of hygienically and in an environmentally friendly manner; a waste storage and removal area must be provided;

- absence of hazardous or odorous substances in the vinification, ageing and storage premises (odour).

i) – Ageing

- The wines are aged at least until 1 April of the year following that of the harvest.

- The temperature of the containers during the ageing phase must be controlled and less than or equal to 25 °C.

2 – Provisions by type of product

No particular provision.

3 – Provisions relating to packaging

For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 644-36 of the Rural Code;

- the reports of analyses carried out before packaging allowing analytical monitoring of the packaged lots. These reports are kept for a period of six months from the date of packaging.

4 – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of a protected storage place for products packaged in unlabelled bottles, meeting the following conditions:

- temperature: between 5 °C and 22 °C.

5 – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer

The wines may only be placed on the market for the consumer after 15 April of the year following that of the harvest.

b) – Period during which the wines may not circulate between authorised warehousekeepers

No particular provision.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1 – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

2 – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product

3 – Causal interactions

(No text in this version.)

XI. – Transitional measures

No particular provision.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1 – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Mercurey" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered, accompanied by the words "Appellation d'origine contrôlée", the whole in very conspicuous characters.

2 – Particular provisions

The labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that:

- it is a registered lieu-dit (cadastral locality);

- and it appears on the harvest declaration.

The name of the registered lieu-dit is entered immediately after the name of the controlled designation of origin and printed in characters whose dimensions, both in height and in width, are not larger than half those of the characters making up the name of the controlled designation of origin.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

The claim declaration must be sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before circulation between authorised warehousekeepers and at the latest on 1 December of the year of harvest.

It indicates in particular:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied in particular by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

2. Declaration prior to transaction and collections

Every operator wishing to sell in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make a transaction declaration for the lot concerned to the approved control body within time limits set in the control or inspection plan of between six and fifteen working days before any collection.

This declaration, accompanied where applicable by a copy of the purchase contract, specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the identification of the containers;

- the identity of the buyer.

If collections are made for volumes smaller than those set out in the transaction declaration, the operator must inform the control body in writing.

3. Declaration of release for consumption

Each lot of wine intended to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 644-36-I of the Rural Code must be the subject of a declaration of release for consumption to the approved control body within minimum time limits set in the control or inspection plan of between six and fifteen working days before release for consumption.

This declaration may also be drawn up for lots already packaged, within minimum time limits set in the control or inspection plan of between six and fifteen working days before the lots concerned are dispatched from the operator's cellars.

It specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the lot number for wines already packaged;

- the identification of the containers for non-packaged wines.

4. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to dispatch outside the national territory a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must declare it to the approved control body within time limits set in the control or inspection plan of between six and fifteen working days before any dispatch.

5. Fallback declaration

Every operator marketing a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin under a more general appellation must declare it to the defence and management body and to the approved control body:

- at the same time as the declaration prior to transaction, if the wine is the subject of a bulk transaction after the fallback;

- at the same time as the packaging declaration, if the wine is packaged after the fallback;

- within time limits set in the control or inspection plan of between six and fifteen working days following the recording of the fallback in the wine register, if the wine is the subject of a fallback after packaging.

The defence and management body and the approved control body inform, respectively and without delay, the defence and management body of the more general appellation concerned and the approved control body for the more general appellation concerned.

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the approved control body a quarterly summary.

7. Declaration of equipment for TSE

Every operator holding a concentration apparatus must declare it upon purchase to the defence and management body, specifying its specifications. The defence and management body keeps an up-to-date list of operators holding such equipment and sends it each year to the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the latest on 1 September.

Every operator using a service provider declares it to the defence and management body, which draws up the list of these operators and sends it each year to the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the latest on 1 September.

8. Reworking of parcels

Before any development or any works liable to modify the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer (including any addition of exogenous soil) or the structuring elements of the landscape of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, a declaration must be sent by the operator to the defence and management body at least 4 weeks before the planned start date of the works. The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

9. Derogatory system

Operators carrying out at least five transactions per week and/or at least forty-two preparations for release for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 644-36-I of the Rural Code per year may group their transaction, release-for-consumption and fallback declarations. In this case, they must provide the approved control body with their forecast of transactions, releases for consumption and fallbacks, then send the quarterly summary of all the declarations referred to in points 2, 3 and 5 above.

II. – Keeping of registers

1. General plan of the storage and vinification places

Every vinifying operator must keep up to date and available for the approved control body a general plan of the storage and vinification places, allowing in particular the number, designation and capacity of the containers to be identified.

2. TSE register

Every operator carrying out partial concentration of musts must keep an up-to-date TSE register including in particular:

- the identification of the initial lot (volume and potential alcoholic strength);

- the volume of water evaporated;

- the identification of the lot after concentration (volume and potential alcoholic strength).

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Location of operators within the immediate proximity area	Documentary check
A2 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary check (up-to-date CVI parcel record); visit in the field
A3 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of derogatory measures, planting density, plant material)	Documentary check and field visits (details in the inspection plan)
A4 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	
Vat capacity	Documentary check: general plan of the storage places; on-site visit

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	**EVALUATION METHODS**
Ageing (temperature control and length of ageing)	Documentary check: temperature records and packaging declaration; on-site visit
State of upkeep of the cellar and equipment (hygiene)	On-site visit
Protected storage place and storage conditions (T °C)	Documentary check: temperature records; on-site visit
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard	
Pruning	Visit in the field
Average maximum load per parcel	Visit in the field
Cultivation and sanitary condition of the vine (sanitary condition of foliage and berries, upkeep of the soil, upkeep of the trellising)	Visit in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	
Ripeness of the grapes	Documentary check: must analysis report; visit in the field
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage	
Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…)	Documentary check: declaration of equipment and TSE register, enrichment, acidification and de-acidification register; on-site visit
Stock accounts, analytical traceability	Documentary check: keeping of registers by operators, analysis reports
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	Documentary check (declaration obligations); visit in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary check (check of declarations, monitoring of authorisations granted by the INAO services after their investigation of the operator's individual request)
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary check: monitoring of destruction certificates
Claim declaration	Documentary check and on-site visit: compliance with procedures and time limits, consistency with the harvest and production declarations; check of the release of products into circulation
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Packaged wines	Analytical and organoleptic examination before or after packaging
Non-packaged wines	Analytical and organoleptic examination at transaction
Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all lots
D – PRESENTATION OF THE PRODUCTS	
Labelling	On-site visit

II. – References concerning the control structure

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The INAO is the control authority ensuring compliance with the provisions of the present specification for products benefiting from the controlled designation of origin.